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All Fur Love

IT'S RAINING CATS AND DOGS IN THE WORLD OF INDIAN LITERARY ANTHOLOGIES

Funny, sad and sometimes astonishing, these two must-have books are really more about people than about their non-human companions. The writing is average, but the stories are riveting all the same.

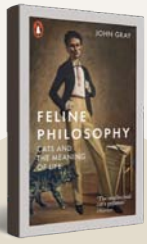
They provide peepholes into the intimate lives of urban, privileged and educated pet owners talking about the love that goes beyond family, property, reason. The great majority of the narrators are Indians whose lives have been fundamentally altered by the sometimes absurd but often unbearable sweetness that takes the shape of furry, four-footed creatures.

Though conceived of and published entirely separately, the books might as well be companion volumes. A couple of writers appear in both. They contain illustrations and photographs but they're not aimed at children. They're handsome and well-designed but both contain small fleas in the form of proofing errors. It's not possible to say which book is better than the other, any more than it's possible to say which is better, cat or dog.

Cat People (*CAT*) includes pieces of narrative

Chasing their Tale

Best new beastly books



FELINE PHILOSOPHY
Cats and the Meaning of Life
by John Gray
PENGUIN
₹699; 128 pages

Michel de Montaigne had asked, "When I play with my cat, how do I know she is not passing time with me rather than I with her?" Gray tries to answer this and other cat-related philosophical queries here.